

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting January 6th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mLWEsW97QXE
Publication Date	2025-01-07T02:54:16Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Commissioner Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 6, <U+063A><U+064A><U+0631> <U+0645><U+062D><U+062F><U+062F>

Report Publication: Structured Municipal Meeting Analysis

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners was called to order by the presiding officer at approximately 3 minutes past the hour **00:00:29**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Commissioner Brand, Commissioner Henry, and Commissioner Rigan.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Commissioner Henry (nominated and approved as President for the year).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance, alongside a moment of remembrance for the late Jimmy Carter and residents affected by events in New Orleans [00:00:37](#).
 - **Reorganization:**
 - Commissioner Henry was nominated and approved as President for the upcoming year (Roll Call: Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes, Rigan <U+2013> Yes) [00:01:58](#).
 - Commissioner Brand was nominated and approved as Vice President (Roll Call: Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:02:45](#).
 - **Annual Appointments:** [00:03:16](#) The board reviewed and approved executive, board, and commission annual appointments (including 9-11 Director Fred Cummings, County Attorney John Brooke, and various community boards).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call (Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:05:34](#).
 - **Miscellaneous Board Appointments:** [00:05:49](#) Review of appointments with staggered terms (Airport Authority, Board of Health, Corrections Board, etc.). Note made of a Democrat vacancy on the Board of Zoning Appeals (BZA) requiring letters of interest.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by Roll Call (Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:08:14](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** [00:08:50](#) Minutes for the December 16 commissioner meeting and December 30 special meeting were not yet completed.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Table business and minutes tabled by Roll Call (Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:09:02](#).
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:09:13](#) **Item Identifier & Title:** Absolute Title for Deed Sales Service Contract
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Stephen Brand / Ed
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding sourcing tax deed sale services outside the county (Absolute Title LLC out of Madison County) versus local options. Explanations included historical context, statutory cost caps (\$250), prior lack of formal contracts, and coordination needs with new vendor SRI and title search processes. Commissioner Brand emphasized a preference for local sourcing when competitive.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None noted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Contract acknowledged / advanced under discussion (no explicit opposing vote recorded; consensus to move forward with formal contract protections).
- [00:04:39](#) **Item Identifier & Title:** 9-11 Center Chair Lease Renewal
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Cummings

- **Deliberation Summary:** Renewal of a 3-year lease for 247 specialized 24/7 dispatch chairs through an Ohio vendor, totaling \$22,500 (approx. \$7,211.16/year). Commissioners questioned the lack of local vendor availability and sought exit clauses or annual opt-outs in the agreement's severability terms.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** 00:19:36 Tabled for legal review and language amendments regarding annual cancellation options (Approved to table by Roll Call: Brand <U+2013> Yes, Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes).
- 00:20:02 **Item Identifier & Title:** Old Business <U+2013> Solar Moratorium Update
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Update on the 6-month solar moratorium. A citizen advisory committee drafted a revised solar ordinance featuring stricter setbacks and property value guarantees. The proposal is slated for review before submission to the Plan Commission for a public hearing prior to March 1st. Discussion also touched on National Grid Renewables' outreach in Wharton.
- 00:24:07 **Item Identifier & Title:** Weights and Measures December Report
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric St. (Inspector of Weights and Measures)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of monthly inspection metrics (1,730 total inspections), covering truck/vehicle scales, gas pumps (noting 7 rejections, mostly over-delivering), packaged foods, and firewood bundles. Inspector St. also highlighted a successful state convention hosted in Muncie utilizing OmniSource.
- 00:32:01 **Item Identifier & Title:** Payment of Claims
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of general claims totaling \$4,217,25.75 (Note: transcript indicates \$4.2M+). Commissioners discussed improving online transparency for claim registers, tracking invoice descriptions from department heads, and verifying payment processes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Brand <U+2013> Yes, Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) 00:40:47.
- 00:41:06 **Item Identifier & Title:** Payment of ARPA Claims
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funding allocations, including Mental Health Facility (\$6.1M+ context noted in review), Ron Relief Sewer (\$1.5M), County buildings, storm water projects, and the Revenue Replacement fund balance (\$4.9M+).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) 00:41:12.
- 00:43:08 **Item Identifier & Title:** Payment of False Settlement
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Distribution of \$36,322.00 to small towns and local taxing units.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Brand <U+2013> Yes, Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:43:34](#).
 - [00:43:38](#) **Item Identifier & Title:** Payment of Payroll (Period ending 12/18/2024)
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Auditor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Payroll authorization totaling \$1,030,320. Commissioners emphasized ensuring timely employee compensation while requesting more detailed reporting moving forward.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Brand <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:44:12](#).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period.* [00:44:21](#)
-

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - 13 open job positions are currently posted outside the Commissioner's Office on the 3rd floor.
 - Commissioner Brand announced administrative initiatives: a comprehensive inventory of county-owned/take-home vehicles, implementation of employee onboarding kiosks with HR, review of the 32.5-hour work week and FLSA exempt classifications, and a new employee-of-the-month program.
 - Discussion initiated regarding Indiana House Bill 1381 concerning state preemption of local authority over solar siting and setbacks; commissioners agreed to review the legislation for potential opposition.
 - Next regular commissioner meeting scheduled for **Tuesday, January 21 at 9:00 AM**.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* The board placed the meeting into **Recess** (as per operational statute allowing commissioners to remain on duty) by Roll Call vote (Brand <U+2013> Yes, Rigan <U+2013> Yes, Henry <U+2013> Yes) [00:49:37](#).
-